

Occupational Health and Absence Adviser

FF06 HR, recruitment and L and D · ISCO-08 242 · CBS 1035 Inspecteurs veiligheid, gezondheid en medische vakspecialisten · seniority medior · Also known as: Absence Management Adviser, Occupational Health Adviser

Advises the employer and managers on absence guidance, working conditions and return to work, and monitors compliance with statutory absence steps.

The occupational health and absence adviser works between manager, employee and company doctor and keeps the absence process and statutory deadlines on track. Unlike the occupational expert, this role does not give a formal judgement on work capacity but organises the process and prevention. Selection stalls because knowledge of the rules is the main criterion, while the role depends on holding to account a manager who postpones the conversation with a sick employee and lets a deadline lapse.

Key figures for this profile

23 skills · 5 competencies to measure · 4 knockout skills · centre of gravity: Leadership and organising 29%, Professional knowledge domains 24%, Collaboration and interpersonal effectiveness 19%

1 Competencies to measure

These are the behavioural and ability constructs in this profile. Each one shows which hrmforce questionnaire measures it.

Competencies to measure	Target level	hrmforce instrument	Assessment method	Behavioural anchor at target level
Listening and probing Competency (50-framework): Luisteren	 N4	Big Fifty, 360 Feedback	360 feedback	Summarises both the content and the feeling of the other party and probes until the real interest behind the request becomes visible.

Competencies to measure	Target level	hrmforce instrument	Assessment method	Behavioural anchor at target level
interpersonal sensitivity Competency (50-framework): Sensitiviteit	 N4	Big Fifty, 360 Feedback, Kleurenprofiel (Jung)	Persoonlijkheidsvragenlijst	Names observed tension or reticence during a conversation and adapts tone, pace and wording accordingly.
organisational awareness Competency (50-framework): Organisatiesensitiviteit	 N4	Big Fifty, Competency Check, 360 Feedback	Situational Judgement Test	Assesses which interests a proposal touches, involves the right people beforehand and chooses a suitable moment to raise it.
integrity and dependability Competency (50-framework): Integriteit	 N4	Big Fifty (schaal Integriteit), 360 Feedback, Structureerd interview	Persoonlijkheidsvragenlijst	Reports a possible conflict of interest on own initiative and asks for review before a decision is taken.
independence Competency (50-framework): Onafhankelijkheid	 N3	Big Fifty, 15PF	Persoonlijkheidsvragenlijst	Takes a decision that departs from the group line, explains the reasoning behind it and accepts the consequences.

2 Full skill profile

Every skill in this profile, sorted by weight. The behavioural anchor under each skill belongs to the target level.

T	Skill	Target level	Weight	Knockout	Assessment method	hrmforce instrument
K	Working conditions and absence policy Develops the policy on sustainable employability and absence, analyses the figures and tackles causes in the work itself.	 N5	5	yes	Kennistoets	Kennistoets (klantspecifiek), Ontwikkelgesprek
V	Advisory skill Reframes the question behind the question, offers two supported options with consequences and agrees a decision moment.	 N4	5	yes	Assessment center	Competency Check, Structureerd interview
V	Guiding absence and work ability Holds absence conversations without asking for medical details and draws up an action plan with the occupational physician.	 N4	5	no	Situational Judgement Test	Kennistoets (klantspecifiek), Competency Check
K	Applying basic employment law Applies rules on contracts, leave and dismissal correctly in own decisions and involves a lawyer when in doubt.	 N4	5	yes	Kennistoets	Kennistoets (klantspecifiek)

T	Skill	Target level	Weight	Knockout	Assessment method	hrmforce instrument
K	HR policy and instruments Independently applies HR instruments to a department's issues and advises the manager on their appropriate use.	 N4	5	yes	Kennistoets	Kennistoets (klantspecifiek), Competency Check
G	Listening and probing Summarises both the content and the feeling of the other party and probes until the real interest behind the request becomes visible.	 N4	4	no	360 feedback	Big Fifty, 360 Feedback
G	interpersonal sensitivity Names observed tension or reticence during a conversation and adapts tone, pace and wording accordingly.	 N4	4	no	Persoonlijkheidsvragenlijst	Big Fifty, 360 Feedback, Kleurenprofiel (Jung)
G	organisational awareness Assesses which interests a proposal touches, involves the right people beforehand and chooses a suitable moment to raise it.	 N4	4	no	Situational Judgement Test	Big Fifty, Competency Check, 360 Feedback

T	Skill	Target level	Weight	Knockout	Assessment method	hrmforce instrument
G	integrity and dependability Reports a possible conflict of interest on own initiative and asks for review before a decision is taken.	 N4	4	no	Persoonlijkheidsvragenlijst	Big Fifty (schaal Integriteit), 360 Feedback, Structureerd interview
V	Organising learning and development Independently draws up a training plan for a department, chooses learning formats and measures whether the intended behaviour changes.	 N3	4	no	Portfolio/bewijsstuk	Ontwikkelgesprek, Competency Check
V	Carrying out workplace risk assessment Carries out a risk assessment for a process independently, weighs likelihood against effect and proposes prioritised measures.	 N3	4	no	Werkproef	Kennistoets (klantspecifiek), Werkproef
G	independence Takes a decision that departs from the group line, explains the reasoning behind it and accepts the consequences.	 N3	3	no	Persoonlijkheidsvragenlijst	Big Fifty, 15PF

T	Skill	Target level	Weight	Knockout	Assessment method	hrmforce instrument
V	Coaching Holds coaching conversations with open questions, names patterns in behaviour and lets the other person formulate a learning goal.	 N3	3	no	Simulatie	Competency Check, 360 Feedback, Ontwikkelgesprek
V	Change management Makes a change approach for the team with those involved, chooses interventions per group and follows the implementation.	 N3	3	no	Assessment center	Competency Check, 360 Feedback
V	Workforce planning and strategic workforce planning Draws up a staffing forecast for the own team including turnover and retirement and names the vacancies to fill.	 N3	3	no	Werkproef	Kennistoets (klantspecifiek), Werkproef
V	Applying reward and job evaluation Grades a job with the chosen system, substantiates the classification in writing and explains the outcome to the person involved.	 N3	3	no	Kennistoets	Kennistoets (klantspecifiek), Werkproef

T	Skill	Target level	Weight	Knockout	Assessment method	hrmforce instrument
K	GDPR and privacy in practice Judges in own processes whether a legal basis exists, applies data minimisation and handles requests from data subjects correctly.	 N3	3	no	Kennistoets	Kennistoets (klantspecifiek)
K	Labour relations and works councils Independently consults the works council on an intended change and seeks support within the given frameworks.	 N3	3	no	Kennistoets	Kennistoets (klantspecifiek), Competency Check
V	Working ergonomically Adapts own workplace and task sequence to the job, alternates operations and points out unfavourable postures to colleagues.	 N3	3	no	Praktijkobservatie	Werkproef
V	Data analysis Carries out a predefined analysis step on a supplied data set and records the outcome in the agreed format.	 N2	2	no	Werkproef	Ability Scan, Werkproef

T	Skill	Target level	Weight	Knockout	Assessment method	hrmforce instrument
V	Prompting and task delegation to AI Gives an AI tool a single task with a clear question and required format and uses the result after checking it.	 N2	2	no	Werkproef	Werkproef, Portfolio
K	Assessment and selection methodology Administers a test under supervision according to the manual and records the outcomes without own interpretation.	 N2	2	no	Certificaat/diploma	Competency Check, Kennistoets (klantspecifiek)
V	Recruiting and selecting Carries out recruitment tasks such as posting a vacancy text and scheduling interviews according to procedure.	 N1	1	no	Structureerd interview	Structureerd interview, Kennistoets (klantspecifiek), Werkproef

3 Levels per seniority

The same profile with the job family seniority adjustment applied. Target levels are clamped to 1 to 5.

Skill	medior	senior
Working conditions and absence policy	N5	N5
Advisory skill	N4	N4
Guiding absence and work ability	N4	N5
Applying basic employment law	N4	N4
HR policy and instruments	N4	N5
Listening and probing	N4	N5
interpersonal sensitivity	N4	N5
organisational awareness	N4	N5
integrity and dependability	N4	N5
Organising learning and development	N3	N4
Carrying out workplace risk assessment	N3	N4
independence	N3	N4
Coaching	N3	N4
Change management	N3	N4
Workforce planning and strategic workforce planning	N3	N4
Applying reward and job evaluation	N3	N4
GDPR and privacy in practice	N3	N4
Labour relations and works councils	N3	N4
Working ergonomically	N3	N4
Data analysis	N2	N3
Prompting and task delegation to AI	N2	N3
Assessment and selection methodology	N2	N2
Recruiting and selecting	N1	N1

4 The proficiency scale

Level	Label	Autonomy	Complexity	Scope	Depth of knowledge
N1	Guided	works under supervision and follows instruction	routine, one variable at a time	own task	basic understanding of terminology
N2	Applying	works independently within set frameworks	familiar situations with limited variation	own role	working knowledge, applies standard approach
N3	Proficient	sets own approach and seeks input proactively	several variables, some ambiguity	own team or process	thorough knowledge, weighs alternatives
N4	Advanced	directs others and decides on the approach	complex, with conflicting interests	several teams or a department	in-depth knowledge, advises others
N5	Leading	sets the standard and the policy	strategic, under high uncertainty	organisation, value chain or profession	authority, advances the profession

5 Behavioural anchors per skill

Anchors sit at N1, N3 and N5. N2 and N4 are deliberately not anchored: raters interpolate between them, following the O*NET convention.

Skill	N1	N3	N5
Working conditions and absence policy Knows the rules for safe and healthy work and the steps in absence and reintegration and applies them in conversations and files.	Registers absence reports according to procedure and flags when a statutory step in the file is due.	Independently holds absence conversations, draws up an action plan with company doctor and manager and keeps the file complete.	Develops the policy on sustainable employability and absence, analyses the figures and tackles causes in the work itself.
Advisory skill Sharpening the question of a client and delivering a well founded recommendation in a way that the receiver adopts and implements it.	Supplies requested information and explains a standard recommendation following the fixed structure used by the team.	Reframes the question behind the question, offers two supported options with consequences and agrees a decision moment.	Advises the board on issues with conflicting interests, challenges established assumptions and safeguards the quality of advice across the organisation.

Skill	N1	N3	N5
Guiding absence and work ability Holding absence conversations, monitoring work ability and workload capacity and agreeing with occupational physician and employee on recovery and return to work.	Reports absence according to the fixed procedure and keeps contact with the absent colleague at agreed moments.	Holds absence conversations without asking for medical details and draws up an action plan with the occupational physician.	Sets the organisation wide absence and vitality policy, tracks causes across departments and steers on structural root causes.
Applying basic employment law Knowing and applying rules on employment contracts, working hours, dismissal and employee participation in personnel decisions, and knowing when legal advice is needed.	Looks up in the collective agreement or staff handbook which rule applies to a question.	Applies rules on contracts, leave and dismissal correctly in own decisions and involves a lawyer when in doubt.	Sets the employment law policy of the organisation, negotiates terms of employment with trade unions and assesses precedents and legal risks.
HR policy and instruments Develops and manages HR instruments such as job architecture, appraisal, reward and mobility and links them to the organisation's staffing needs.	Explains to an employee which HR scheme applies and refers deviant situations to the adviser.	Independently applies HR instruments to a department's issues and advises the manager on their appropriate use.	Determines the organisation's HR policy, links it to the strategy and sets frameworks for all HR instruments.
Listening and probing Taking in the message of the other party fully, checking whether it is understood correctly and using targeted questions to surface underlying interests and assumptions.	Lets the other person finish speaking, takes notes and afterwards asks about anything that stayed unclear.	Summarises both the content and the feeling of the other party and probes until the real interest behind the request becomes visible.	Picks up sensitive signals in conversations with directors and supervisors and uses them to adjust organisational policy in good time.
Interpersonal sensitivity Noticing verbal and non-verbal signals from others, naming what stands out and adjusting own behaviour accordingly during the contact.	Notices when a conversation partner disengages or hesitates and asks whether the explanation is clear.	Names observed tension or reticence during a conversation and adapts tone, pace and wording accordingly.	Trains others in recognising social signals and uses that insight when designing sensitive change processes across the organisation.
Organisational awareness Recognising how formal and informal relations, interests and decision making work in the organisation and taking these into account in own actions.	Asks who needs to be involved in a topic before a proposal is shared with others.	Assesses which interests a proposal touches, involves the right people beforehand and chooses a suitable moment to raise it.	Sees through relations between organisational units and external parties and steers decision making by organising support at an early stage.

Skill	N1	N3	N5
integrity and dependability Acting in line with applicable standards and agreements, also without supervision, and being transparent about own interests, mistakes and doubtful cases.	Keeps to agreements and rules of conduct made and reports an own mistake to the manager.	Reports a possible conflict of interest on own initiative and asks for review before a decision is taken.	Sets the organisation's integrity standards, enforces them also with influential parties and explains the resulting choices publicly.
Organising learning and development Determines the learning needs in the organisation, chooses learning formats and providers and organises training including evaluation of its effect.	Arranges the practical side of a training course under guidance and tracks participation and cost.	Independently draws up a training plan for a department, chooses learning formats and measures whether the intended behaviour changes.	Determines the organisation's learning strategy, sets up the learning infrastructure and accounts for the return to the board.
Carrying out workplace risk assessment Maps hazards at a workplace, estimates likelihood and effect and names measures that bring the risk down to an acceptable level.	Walks through the workplace with a checklist and notes down which hazards are visible there.	Carries out a risk assessment for a process independently, weighs likelihood against effect and proposes prioritised measures.	Determines the risk assessment methodology for the organisation, audits its execution and accounts for residual risks to management and regulator.
independence Forming and maintaining an own position on the basis of own judgement, even when the environment or an authority expects something different.	Forms an own opinion on a familiar issue and compares it with the advice of a colleague.	Takes a decision that departs from the group line, explains the reasoning behind it and accepts the consequences.	Protects own professional judgement against pressure from stakeholders in senior forums and makes dissenting positions traceable and explainable.
Coaching Helping employees reflect on their own behaviour and choices through questions, mirroring and feedback, so they take a next step in their work themselves.	Asks a colleague after a job what went well and what they would do differently next time.	Holds coaching conversations with open questions, names patterns in behaviour and lets the other person formulate a learning goal.	Trains managers in coaching behaviour, guides peer supervision groups and determines how coaching is deployed across the organisation.
Change management Planning and guiding change by involving stakeholders, phasing steps, influencing behaviour and tracking the results the change is meant to deliver.	Adapts own way of working to an announced change and asks for explanation when steps are unclear.	Makes a change approach for the team with those involved, chooses interventions per group and follows the implementation.	Leads organisation wide change programmes, aligns with works council and supervisors and sets the change approach of the organisation.

Skill	N1	N3	N5
Workforce planning and strategic workforce planning Determining current and future staffing needs in numbers and qualifications, comparing them with the present workforce and deriving actions for hiring and development.	Supplies data on staffing and turnover and checks the personnel list for errors and duplicates.	Draws up a staffing forecast for the own team including turnover and retirement and names the vacancies to fill.	Builds strategic workforce planning for the whole organisation, links it to strategy and labour market and puts the risks on the executive agenda.
Applying reward and job evaluation Grading jobs with an evaluation system, substantiating salary proposals within the applicable scheme and explaining reward choices to the employee and executive team.	Looks up the correct salary scale for a job and checks the data in the personnel system.	Grades a job with the chosen system, substantiates the classification in writing and explains the outcome to the person involved.	Sets the reward policy and job architecture of the organisation, tests market competitiveness and accounts for the choices to works council and supervisors.
GDPR and privacy in practice Knows privacy legislation requirements for own work, which legal basis and retention period apply and recognises when notification is required.	Processes personal data only according to the applicable work instruction and refers doubtful cases to the privacy officer.	Judges in own processes whether a legal basis exists, applies data minimisation and handles requests from data subjects correctly.	Sets privacy policy, decides on high risk processing operations and represents the organisation towards the supervisory authority.
Labour relations and works councils Knows the rights and roles of employer, trade union and works council and conducts consultation on schemes, reorganisation and collective agreements.	Prepares the meeting documents for the works council and tracks the agreements made and their deadlines.	Independently consults the works council on an intended change and seeks support within the given frameworks.	Determines the organisation's consultation strategy, negotiates collective agreements and mediates when relations have broken down.
Working ergonomically Arranges working height, aids and task sequence so that an operation is carried out in a favourable posture with as little load as possible.	Adjusts chair, work surface or lifting aid as instructed and uses the aids provided for lifting work.	Adapts own workplace and task sequence to the job, alternates operations and points out unfavourable postures to colleagues.	Sets the ergonomic design standard for workplaces, assesses new aids and builds ergonomics into design and purchasing.
Data analysis Prepares and analyses data sets to find patterns, relationships and outliers and connects the outcomes to the original question.	Carries out a predefined analysis step on a supplied data set and records the outcome in the agreed format.	Selects analysis methods for an open question, turns raw data into a working file and supports every conclusion with figures.	Sets the organisation's analysis standards, reviews the analyses of others and establishes new analysis methods in the profession.

Skill	N1	N3	N5
Prompting and task delegation to AI Divides work between person and AI system, formulates task, context and required output format and adjusts based on the output.	Gives an AI tool a single task with a clear question and required format and uses the result after checking it.	Splits a work task into steps, decides which step AI does and which not and improves the instruction based on outcomes.	Develops organisation wide practices for dividing tasks with AI and trains others in effective and responsible instruction giving.
Assessment and selection methodology Selects and uses selection instruments such as tests, interviews and work samples, weighs the outcomes and substantiates an advice on suitability.	Administers a test under supervision according to the manual and records the outcomes without own interpretation.	Independently combines test results and interview data into a substantiated advice and discusses it with candidate and client.	Determines the organisation's selection methodology, tests instruments for reliability and validity and sets guidelines for their use.
Recruiting and selecting Defining vacancies sharply, attracting candidates and making a substantiated selection choice using fixed criteria, structured interviews and assessment instruments.	Carries out recruitment tasks such as posting a vacancy text and scheduling interviews according to procedure.	Sets selection criteria, conducts structured interviews with the same questions per candidate and records the judgement traceably.	Sets the selection policy of the organisation, chooses instruments on validity and equal opportunity and monitors the quality of appointments.

6 Assessment methods and validity

The validities are the corrected meta-analytic estimates from Sackett, Zhang, Berry and Lievens (2022) in the Journal of Applied Psychology, which replace the older Schmidt and Hunter (1998) figures. The spread matters as much as the mean: with a high SD, validity varies strongly by context.

Assessment method	rho	SD	What it is
Kennistoets	0.40	0.13	Test of declarative job knowledge, usually assembled per client.
Assessment center	0.29	0.09	Multiple exercises, multiple assessors, dimension-wise scoring.
Situational Judgement Test	0.12	0.11	Scenario with response options, scored on knowledge or behavioural tendency.
360 feedback	-	-	Multiple raters around the person rate behaviour against behavioural anchors.
Persoonlijkheidsvragenlijst	0.40	0.15	Self-report of behavioural preferences. At hrnforce the Big Fifty and the 15PF.
Portfolio/bewijsstuk	-	-	A collection of prior work or results, assessed against fixed criteria.
Werkproef	0.33	0.09	The candidate performs a representative work sample under standardised conditions.
Simulatie	-	-	Simulated work situation, usually digital, with standardised scoring.
Praktijkobservatie	-	-	Structured workplace observation with a form based on behavioural anchors.
Certificaat/diploma	-	-	Formal proof of completed education or examination.
Structureerd interview	0.42	0.19	Behaviour-based interview with fixed questions and a rating scale per question.

7 Assessment instruments for this job

hrnforce instrument	Skills	What it measures
Kennistoets (klantspecifiek)	11	Toets van vakkennis, per klant samengesteld
Competency Check	9	Competentiebeoordeling op gedragsniveau
Werkproef	7	Representatief werkfragment onder gestandaardiseerde condities
360 Feedback	6	Meervoudige beoordeling op gedragsankers
Big Fifty	4	Persoonlijkheidsvragenlijst, 150 items, 25 factoren

hrmforce instrument	Skills	What it measures
Ontwikkелgesprek	3	Gestructureerd ontwikkelgesprek
Structureerd interview	3	Gedraggericht interview met vaste opzet
Kleurenprofiel (Jung)	1	Vier kleurentypen, gekoppeld aan Big Fifty-factoren
Big Fifty (schaal Integriteit)	1	
15PF	1	Persoonlijkheidsprofiel, korter alternatief voor de Big Fifty
Ability Scan	1	Capaciteitentest: verbaal, numeriek en abstract redeneervermogen
Portfolio	1	Beoordeling van eerder werk tegen vaste criteria

8 How to use this profile

1. Agree the profile with the hiring manager before the first candidate is measured. Weights shifted afterwards make the outcome indefensible.
2. Choose the assessment method per skill from the Assessment method column. Combine at most three methods per candidate.
3. Calibrate the assessors in a two-hour session using the anchors in chapter 5. Anchors without rater training deliver little.
4. Fill in the match calculator and discuss the gaps in the development conversation. Type A and type G are selection criteria, not one-quarter development goals.

Source: hrmforce Skills Framework 2.0, version 2.0.0, built 2026-09-08. Crosswalks to ESCO v1.2.1, O*NET 31.0, Lightcast Open Skills, SFIA 9, DigComp 3.0, EntreComp, LifeComp, GreenComp, AILit, WEF Future of Jobs 2025, ISCO-08 and the Dutch CBS occupational classification BRC 2014 edition 2025. This profile is a starting point, not a standard: align it with your own organisation before selecting on it.